FCPS AI Guidance for Faculty and Staff: Data and Student Privacy Passages

Excerpted verbatim from *Artificial Intelligence Guidance for FCPS Faculty and Staff (Fairfax County Public Schools, Virginia)*. The source has no page numbers; locations are given by section. Ellipses (…) mark omitted text. The source is a web page whose text was captured from an earlier retrieval and no longer loads online; it has no page numbers.

Our Approach to AI in FCPS: Leverage AI Tools Ethically and Responsibly (excerpt)

Source: web page, section 'Our Approach to AI in FCPS'

AI should be used in ways that protect privacy, support learning, uphold academic integrity, and avoid harm.

- Protect privacy, security, and data rights of people in our community.

Protect Data and Privacy

Source: web page, section 'Protect Data and Privacy'

Protecting students, staff, and confidential information is a shared responsibility.

Staff are expected to:

- Never enter personally identifiable, confidential, or sensitive information into unapproved AI tools.
- Use only approved AI tools when working with protected information.
- Follow all applicable FCPS policies, state and federal laws, and data privacy requirements.
- Report suspected privacy or security concerns through established FCPS procedures.

What This Looks Like In Practice

Appropriate Use

- Drafting a family newsletter without student information.
- Creating lesson ideas using general prompts.
- Brainstorming instructional strategies.

Not Appropriate

- Uploading student work containing names to an unapproved AI tool.
- Entering IEP, 504, disciplinary, or personnel information into public AI tools.

Check AI Tool Approval Before Use

Source: web page, section 'Check AI Tool Approval Before Use'

Not all AI tools have been reviewed for FCPS use.

Staff are expected to:

- Verify approval in the Digital Ecosystem Library (DEL).
- Follow the approved audience and usage guidance.
- Use only approved AI tools on FCPS devices and networks.

- If a tool is not approved, do not use it for FCPS work involving students or confidential information.

Planning Examples and Educator AI Literacies (excerpt)

Source: web page, sections 'Professional Practice' and 'Educator AI Literacies'

Staff remain responsible for selecting appropriate tools, protecting privacy, reviewing AI-generated content, and applying professional judgment.

Apply professional judgment by verifying AI outputs, protecting privacy, and considering ethics, bias, and transparency.

Related: Parent and Guardian Permission and Approved Tools for Students (excerpt)

Source: web page, sections 'Set Clear Student AI Use Expectations' and 'Academic Integrity'. Included because permission and approved-tool rules are tied to student data protection; remove if out of scope.

It is also important to get parent or guardian permission.

Students may not use unapproved AI tools on FCPS-issued devices.

- Obtain parent or guardian permission.

Avoid AI Detection Tools (excerpt)

Source: web page, section 'Academic Integrity'

AI detection tools are unreliable, may create privacy concerns, and are not endorsed by FCPS.

Partnering with Families: Key Messages and Making Informed Choices About AI Tools

Source: web page, section 'Partnering with Families'

Protecting student data and privacy is a shared priority between schools and families.

Making Informed Choices About AI Tools (sample family letter)

Ask these quick questions together:

- What happens to the data?
- Does the tool collect, share, or store personal information?
- Who owns the work?
- Will your child keep rights to their writing, images, or projects once entered?
- Can data be deleted later?
- Is there an option to remove information if you change your mind?
- Is it age-appropriate?
- Many tools have age requirements (often 13+ or 18+).

Reviewing privacy policies and terms of service helps your child build responsible digital habits and keeps their ideas at the center of learning.

Ideas for Family Conversations (excerpt)

Source: web page, section 'Partnering with Families'

- Most AI tools are designed for ages 13+ (some 18+). Families decide what’s appropriate at home.
- Teachers will only use AI tools approved in the DEL. No student will be required to use unapproved tools.

Guidance on Personal Devices: How Families Can Support

Source: web page, section 'Partnering with Families'

- Read the tool’s terms of service and privacy policy with your child.
- Discuss what kind of information the tool collects, how it may be used, and whether data can be deleted.
- Confirm age requirements for use.
- Talk about who owns the work once it’s entered and whether rights remain with the student.
- Encourage your child to pause and ask: “What information am I sharing, and do I feel comfortable with this?"

Building Digital Citizenship Together (excerpt)

- Use reviews of privacy policies as opportunities to practice digital literacy skills.

Resources to Share with Families (excerpt)

Source: web page, section 'Partnering with Families'

- FCPS Digital Ecosystem Library (DEL) - Approved AI tools for students and staff.